

Pocket — System Design Document

Read-later web app with AI summaries, text-to-speech, and reading streaks

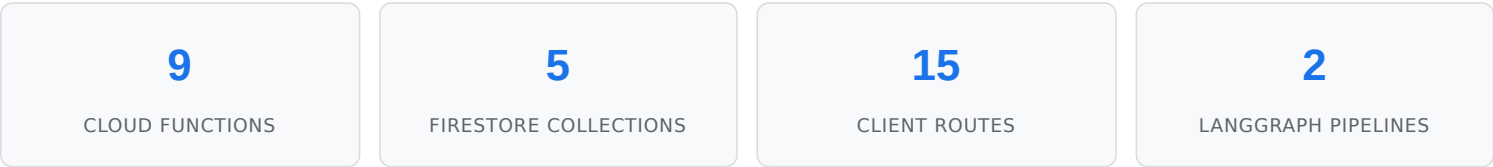
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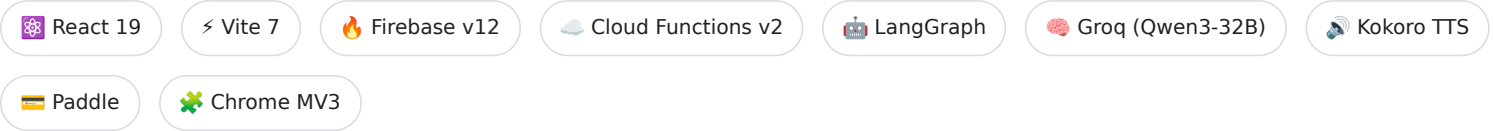
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1. System Overview

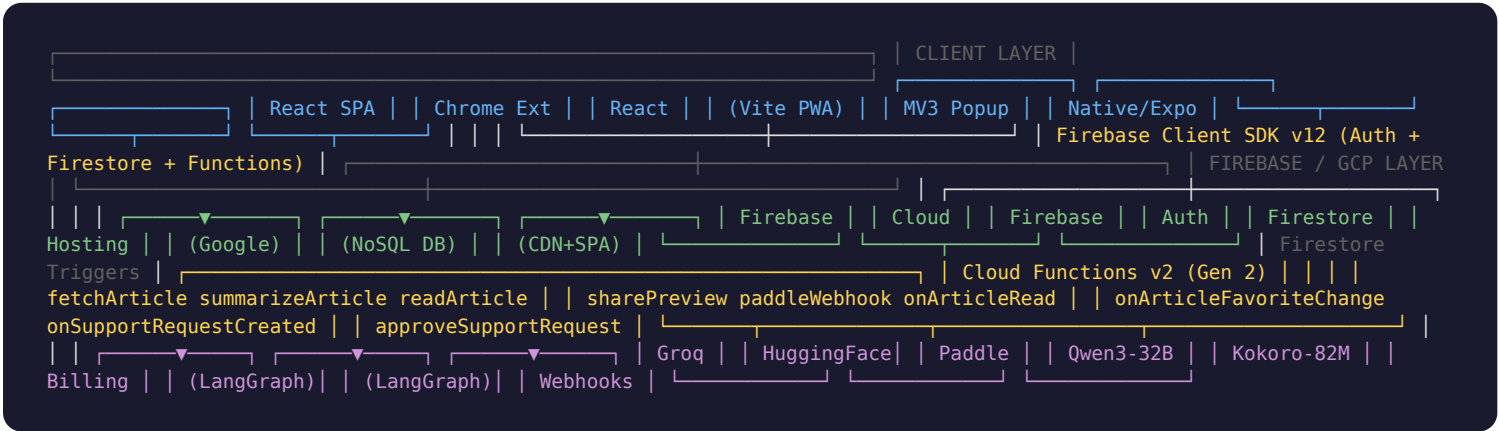
Pocket is a full-stack read-later application built on the Firebase ecosystem. Users save articles from the web, which are server-side fetched, parsed, and stored in Firestore. Premium features include AI-powered summaries (Groq LLM via LangGraph), AI text-to-speech (HuggingFace Kokoro), highlights, collections, and reading streak gamification.



TECH STACK



2. High-Level Architecture



3. Frontend Architecture

3.1 Project Structure

```
src/
├─ App.jsx                # Route definitions + auth guards
├─ main.jsx               # Vite entry point
├─ index.css              # Global CSS variables + reset
├─
├─ components/            # Reusable UI components
│   ├─ Layout.jsx         # Sidebar + header + mobile nav shell
│   ├─ ArticleCard.jsx    # Article list item (used in MyList, Archive, etc.)
│   ├─ AddArticleModal.jsx # URL input modal for saving articles
│   ├─ ImportModal.jsx    # CSV batch import modal
│   ├─ EditorPicks.jsx    # Curated article recommendations
│   ├─ FeaturedArticle.jsx # Most-liked article (from articleStats)
│   ├─ StreakBadge.jsx    # Reading streak flame + badges dropdown
│   ├─ ShareModal.jsx     # Share link generation (Bitly-style)
│   ├─ HighlightToolbar.jsx # Text selection highlighting (premium)
│   └─ VideoPlayer.jsx    # YouTube embed player
├─
├─ pages/                 # Route-level components
│   ├─ Landing.jsx        # Marketing page (guests only)
│   ├─ Login.jsx          # Google OAuth sign-in
│   ├─ MyList.jsx         # Main article list (home)
│   ├─ Archive.jsx        # Archived articles
│   ├─ Favorites.jsx      # Favorited articles
│   ├─ Tags.jsx           # Tag filtering view
│   ├─ Collections.jsx    # Premium: curated collections
│   ├─ Reader.jsx         # Full article reader + TTS + summary
│   ├─ SaveHandler.jsx    # /save?url=... share target handler
│   ├─ Premium.jsx        # Pricing + checkout
│   ├─ Support.jsx        # Support ticket form
│   ├─ About.jsx          # Version history + release notes
│   └─ BlogReadingToolkit.jsx # Internal blog post
├─
├─ context/
│   ├─ AuthContext.jsx    # Firebase Auth state + user profile
│   └─ ThemeContext.jsx   # Light/dark theme toggle
├─
├─ firebase/
│   ├─ config.js          # Firebase app initialization
│   ├─ auth.js            # Auth helpers (login, logout, onAuthChange)
│   └─ articles.js        # Firestore CRUD for articles + user profiles
├─
├─ hooks/
│   ├─ usePremium.js       # Premium status hook
│   └─ useScrollRestore.js # Scroll position restoration on navigation
├─
└─ utils/
    └─ articleFetcher.js   # Cloud Function callable wrappers
```

3.2 Route Map

PATH	COMPONENT	AUTH	LAYOUT
/	Landing (guest) / MyList (user)	Dynamic	Conditional
/archive	Archive	Required	Yes

PATH	COMPONENT	AUTH	LAYOUT
/favorites	Favorites	Required	Yes
/tags , /tags/:tag	Tags	Required	Yes
/collections	Collections	Required	Yes
/read/:id	Reader	Required	No (fullscreen)
/save?url=...	SaveHandler	Required	No
/premium	Premium	Required	Yes
/support	Support	Required	Yes
/about	About	Required	Yes
/p/:code	ShareRedirect	No	No
/blog/reading-toolkit	BlogReadingToolkit	No	No
/terms , /privacy , /refund	Legal pages	No	No
/login	Login	Guest only	No

3.3 State Management

```
ThemeProvider ← localStorage ('theme': 'light' | 'dark') | AuthProvider ← Firebase Auth + Firestore user profile | — user: Firebase User object (uid, email, displayName) | — userProfile: Firestore /users/{uid} doc (isPremium, streaks, badges) | — isPremium: boolean (derived from userProfile) | — refreshProfile(): manually refetch profile from Firestore | — Component Tree — useAuth() → access user + profile + premium status — usePremium() → isPremium + refreshProfile shorthand — useTheme() → theme + toggle()
```

3.4 Build Configuration

SETTING	VALUE
Bundler	Vite 7 + React plugin
Output	dist/ (SPA with index.html fallback)
Code splitting	Manual chunks: firebase , readability , router , vendor
Bundle size	~328KB app + ~359KB firebase (gzipped: ~103KB + ~112KB)
Styling	CSS Modules (*.module.css)
PWA	Service worker (sw.js) + manifest.webmanifest

4. Backend — Cloud Functions

All Cloud Functions are defined in `functions/index.js` (CommonJS, Node 20). They run on Cloud Functions v2 (Gen 2) in `us-central1`.

FUNCTION	TRIGGER	MEMORY	TIMEOUT	SECRETS	PURPOSE
<code>fetchArticle</code>	onCall (HTTPS)	512 MiB	30s	—	Server-side article fetcher. JSDOM + Readability parsing with Wayback Machine fallback. Handles Twitter/oEmbed, YouTube transcripts.
<code>summarizeArticle</code>	onCall (HTTPS)	512 MiB	60s	GROQ_API_KEY	LangGraph pipeline: assess word count → LLM summarize (Groq Qwen3-32B). Returns summary, key points, suggested tags.
<code>readArticle</code>	onCall (HTTPS)	512 MiB	120s	HF_API_KEY	LangGraph pipeline: prepare text chunks → synthesize via Kokoro TTS (HuggingFace). Returns base64 audio chunks.
<code>sharePreview</code>	onRequest (HTTP)	256 MiB	15s	—	OG meta tag server for share links. <code>/p/{code}</code> → reads <code>/shares/{code}</code> → returns HTML with OG tags + redirect.
<code>paddleWebhook</code>	onRequest (HTTP)	256 MiB	15s	PADDLE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	Paddle Billing webhook. HMAC-SHA256 signature verification. Sets/revokes <code>isPremium</code> on user doc.
<code>onArticleFavoriteChange</code>	Firestore trigger	256 MiB	—	—	Maintains <code>/articleStats/{urlHash}</code> favorite counts when <code>isFavorite</code> toggles.
<code>onArticleRead</code>	Firestore trigger	256 MiB	—	—	Updates reading streak, total articles read, and awards badges when <code>isRead</code> flips to true.
<code>onSupportRequestCreated</code>	Firestore trigger	256 MiB	—	GMAIL_APP_PASSWORD	Sends email notification to admin when a support ticket is created.
<code>approveSupportRequest</code>	onCall (HTTPS)	256 MiB	—	GITHUB_TOKEN	Admin-only. Creates GitHub issue with <code>claude-</code>

FUNCTION	TRIGGER	MEMORY	TIMEOUT	SECRETS	PURPOSE
					task label from approved support requests.

4.1 Article Fetch Pipeline

```
Client → fetchArticle Cloud Function | └─ Is Twitter/X? → oEmbed API → sanitize HTML → return | └─ Is YouTube? → extract ytInitialPlayerResponse | └─ title, thumbnail, description | └─ fetch captions (JSON3) → parse transcript | └─ Regular URL | └─ fetch(url, headers) → HTTP 200? → parse | └─ HTTP 403/429/503? | └─ Wayback Machine fallback | web.archive.org/web/20260101000000/{url} | └─ Parse HTML | └─ JSDOM + Readability (primary) | └─ Fallback selectors if Readability returns null: | article, [role="main"], main, .post-content, | .entry-content, .article-body, #content, etc. | └─ OG meta extraction (title, image, description) | └─ sanitize-html (whitelist tags + safe CSS)
```

4.2 Article Fetch — Known Failure Modes

FAILURE	CAUSE	MITIGATION
JavaScript-rendered SPA	JSDOM doesn't execute JS. React/Next.js apps return empty <code><div id="root"></code>	OG meta returned; content empty. Future: Puppeteer headless browser
Paywall / login wall	HTTP 403 or JS-gated content	Wayback Machine fallback for archived snapshots
Bot blocking (Cloudflare, Akamai)	Cloud Function IPs flagged as bots	Custom User-Agent + Wayback fallback
Rate limiting	HTTP 429 from publisher	Wayback Machine fallback
Readability returns null	Non-standard HTML structure	14 fallback CSS selectors tried in order

5. Data Model — Firestore

```
Firestore Database | ├── users/{uid} ← user profile + streak data | | uid, displayName, email, photoURL, createdAt | | isPremium, premiumSince, premiumEndedAt | | paddleCustomerId, paddleSubscriptionId | | currentStreak, longestStreak, lastReadDate | | totalArticlesRead, badges[] | | | └── articles/{articleId} ← saved articles | | url, title, excerpt, heroImage, domain | | content, wordCount, estimatedReadTime, authors[] | | tags[], fetchStatus, fetchError | | isRead, isFavorite, isArchived | | readAt, savedAt | | aiSummary, aiKeyPoints[], aiSuggestedTags[] | | isVideo, videoId, transcript[] | | | └── highlights/{highlightId} ← text highlights (premium) | text, color, note, startOffset, endOffset, createdAt | ├── shares/{code} ← Bitly-style share links | url, title, heroImage, excerpt, domain, createdAt | ├── articleStats/{urlHash} ← global favorite counts | url, title, heroImage, excerpt, domain | favoriteCount, lastUpdated | ├── supportRequests/{requestId} ← support tickets | userId, userName, userEmail, title, description | status (pending/approved/rejected/done) | createdAt, approvedAt, rejectedAt | githubIssueUrl, githubIssueNumber | └── errors/{autoId} ← function error logs type, uid, articleId, title, error, timestamp
```

5.1 Firestore Indexes

COLLECTION	FIELDS	SCOPE
supportRequests	userId ASC + createdAt DESC	Collection
articleStats	favoriteCount DESC (single-field, auto)	Collection

Design decision: Articles are sorted client-side (savedAt descending) to avoid composite index requirements. With a 500-article free-tier cap and unlimited for premium, this keeps Firestore costs minimal while avoiding index proliferation.

5.2 Firestore Security Rules

```
rules_version = '2';
service cloud.firestore {
  match /databases/{database}/documents {
    // Users: read/write own doc only. Cannot self-grant isPremium.
    match /users/{userId} {
      allow read:    if auth.uid == userId;
      allow create:  if auth.uid == userId && !data.isPremium;
      allow update:  if auth.uid == userId
                    && newData.isPremium == existingData.isPremium;

      // Articles + highlights: full CRUD for owner
      match /articles/{articleId} { allow read, write: if auth.uid == userId; }
      match /articles/{articleId}/highlights/{hId} { allow read, write: if auth.uid == userId; }
    }

    // Shares: anyone reads (crawlers), auth users create
    match /shares/{id} { allow read: if true; allow create: if auth != null; }

    // ArticleStats: read-only for clients (written by Cloud Function admin SDK)
    match /articleStats/{id} { allow read: if auth != null; }

    // Support: create own, read own + admin, admin can update status
    match /supportRequests/{id} {
      allow create: if auth != null && data.userId == auth.uid;
      allow read:   if data.userId == auth.uid || auth.email == ADMIN;
      allow update: if auth.email == ADMIN;
    }
  }
}
```


6. AI Pipeline — LangGraph

Two AI features are implemented as LangGraph StateGraph pipelines inside Cloud Functions. Each pipeline defines typed state, node functions, conditional routing, and compiles to an executable graph.

6.1 Summarization Pipeline

```
summarizeArticle Cloud Function | | State: { content, title, articleId, uid, wordCount, shouldSkip, | summary,
keyPoints, suggestedTags } | START | ▼ | assess | Pure function. Counts words. | |
wordCount < 50? → END (shouldSkip: true) | ▼ | summarize | LLM call: Groq Qwen3-32B | | System:
"Reply with ONLY valid JSON" | | Strips <think> blocks (Qwen3 thinking mode) | | Persists to Firestore: aiSummary,
aiKeyPoints, aiSuggestedTags | ▼ END → { summary, keyPoints, suggestedTags }
```

6.2 Text-to-Speech Pipeline

```
readArticle Cloud Function | | State: { content, title, chunks[], shouldSkip, | audioChunks[], contentType } | START |
▼ | prepare | Strip HTML → split at sentence boundaries | | → group into ~400 char chunks | | → cap at
~3000 chars total (~2-3 min speech) | | text < 10 chars? → END (shouldSkip: true) | ▼
| synthesize | For each chunk: | | POST api-inference.huggingface.co | | /models/hexgrad/Kokoro-82M | | → base64 encode
audio buffer | ▼ END → { audioChunks: [base64...], contentType: "audio/flac" }
```

LangGraph pattern: Both pipelines use `Annotation.Root()` for typed state, `addConditionalEdges()` for routing, and `compile()` for immutable graph execution. The state flows through each node, with partial updates merged automatically.

7. Authentication & Authorization

```
User → Firebase Auth (Google OAuth 2.0) | |— Sign in → onAuthChange listener fires | |— Sets user state (uid, email, displayName) | |— Fetches /users/{uid} from Firestore | |— Sets userProfile (isPremium, streaks, etc.) | |— ProtectedRoute guard | If !user → store intended path in sessionStorage | → redirect to /login | If user → render children | |— PublicRoute guard | If user → redirect to / | If !user → render children (login page) | |— Cloud Functions request.auth.uid → used for Firestore doc ownership request.auth.token.email → admin check (support approval)
```

AUTHORIZATION LEVELS

ROLE	ACCESS
Guest	Landing page, login, blog, legal pages, share redirects
Free user	Save up to 500 articles, browser TTS, basic search, tags, PWA
Premium user	All free features + AI TTS, AI summaries, highlights, collections, unlimited saves
Admin	Approve/reject support requests → creates GitHub issues

8. Payment System — Paddle

Premium Page | Click "Subscribe" → Paddle.Checkout.open() | customData: { user_id: firebase_uid } | User completes payment on Paddle's hosted checkout | Paddle sends webhook → paddleWebhook Cloud Function | Verify HMAC-SHA256 signature (PADDLE_WEBHOOK_SECRET) | signed = "ts:rawBody" | expected = HMAC(secret, signed) | timing-safe comparison | Extract user_id from custom_data | subscription.activated / .created / transaction.completed | Set isPremium: true, premiumSince, paddleCustomerId | subscription.canceled / .paused | Set isPremium: false, premiumEndedAt

PRICING

PLAN	PRICE	NET (AFTER PADDLE FEES)
Free	\$0	—
Premium Monthly	\$3.99/mo	~\$3.23/mo
Premium Annual	\$29.99/yr (\$2.50/mo)	~\$27.54/yr

9. CI/CD & Deployment

```
git push to master or claude/* | └─ deploy.yml (always runs) | └─ npm ci + npm run build | └─ Deploy Firestore rules + indexes | └─ Deploy to Firebase Hosting (dist/ → CDN) | └─ deploy-functions.yml (only if functions/** changed) | └─ npm ci (functions/) | └─ Sync secrets to GCP Secret Manager: | GITHUB_TOKEN, GROQ_API_KEY, HF_API_KEY, | LEMON_SQUEEZY_API_KEY, LEMON_SQUEEZY_WEBHOOK_SECRET | └─ Deploy each function individually via gcloud: | └─ fetchArticle (gcloud functions deploy, Gen 2) | └─ summarizeArticle (gcloud + GROQ_API_KEY secret) | └─ readArticle (gcloud + HF_API_KEY secret) | └─ sharePreview (gcloud, 256MiB) | └─ paddleWebhook (gcloud + webhook secret) | └─ onArticleFavoriteChange (firebase deploy, Eventarc trigger) | └─ onArticleRead (firebase deploy, Eventarc trigger) | └─ onSupportRequestCreated (firebase deploy + GMAIL_APP_PASSWORD) | └─ approveSupportRequest (gcloud + GITHUB_TOKEN secret)
```

Why gcloud instead of firebase deploy? HTTP-triggered functions are deployed via `gcloud functions deploy` for precise control over memory, timeout, and secrets. Firestore-triggered functions use `firebase deploy` because Eventarc setup requires it.

GITHUB SECRETS

SECRET	USED BY	PURPOSE
FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT	Both workflows	GCP service account JSON for deployment
GROQ_API_KEY	deploy-functions	Groq LLM API for summarization
HF_API_KEY	deploy-functions	HuggingFace API for Kokoro TTS
GHUB_PAT	deploy-functions	GitHub PAT → GITHUB_TOKEN secret for issue creation
LEMON_SQUEEZY_API_KEY	deploy-functions	Legacy (migrated to Paddle)
LEMON_SQUEEZY_WEBHOOK_SECRET	deploy-functions	Legacy (migrated to Paddle)

10. Chrome Extension

Manifest V3 Chrome extension that lets users save the current tab to their Pocket list.

```
extension/
├─ manifest.json      # MV3 manifest (permissions: activeTab, storage, identity)
├─ src/popup.js       # Source → built via vite.config.extension.js
├─ popup.html         # Extension popup UI
├─ popup.bundle.js    # Built IIFE bundle (vite build:ext)
└─ icons/             # Extension icons (16, 48, 128)
```

```
User clicks extension icon | └─ popup.html loads popup.bundle.js └─ Gets current tab URL via chrome.tabs.query() └─
Authenticates via Firebase Auth (cached token in chrome.storage) └─ Calls addArticle() to save URL to Firestore └─
Fires fetchArticle Cloud Function in background └─ Shows "Saved!" confirmation
```

11. Security Architecture

DEFENSE IN DEPTH

LAYER	MECHANISM
Authentication	Firebase Auth (Google OAuth 2.0). All Cloud Functions check <code>request.auth</code> .
Authorization	Firestore rules enforce doc ownership (<code>auth.uid == userId</code>). Premium flag can only be set by Cloud Function admin SDK.
Input sanitization	<code>sanitize-html</code> with whitelist of safe tags and CSS properties. XSS prevention on article content.
Webhook verification	HMAC-SHA256 signature verification for Paddle webhooks. <code>crypto.timingSafeEqual</code> prevents timing attacks.
Secret management	GCP Secret Manager via <code>defineSecret()</code> . Secrets synced from GitHub Secrets during CI/CD.
URL validation	Protocol whitelist (<code>http:</code> , <code>https:</code> only). Domain-specific handling for social URLs.
Content Security	CSS properties whitelisted (no <code>position:fixed</code> , <code>z-index</code>). Links forced to <code>target="_blank" rel="noopener noreferrer"</code> .
Admin access	Email-based admin check (<code>request.auth.token.email === ADMIN_EMAIL</code>)

12. Scaling & Cost Analysis

12.1 Serverless Auto-Scaling

All infrastructure is serverless (Firebase Hosting CDN + Cloud Functions + Firestore). Zero fixed costs — scales to zero when idle, scales up automatically under load.

~\$0.002

COST PER USER/MONTH

~200 DAU

GROQ FREE TIER LIMIT

~100 DAU

HUGGINGFACE FREE TIER LIMIT

#1

PROFITABLE FROM SUBSCRIBER

12.2 Firestore Query Patterns

QUERY	COLLECTION	COMPLEXITY	NOTES
Get user's articles (filtered)	users/{uid}/articles	O(n) scan, n ≤ 500	Free tier capped at 500. Client-side sort avoids composite indexes.
Get featured article	articleStats	O(1)	Single query with orderBy('favoriteCount', 'desc').limit(1)
Check article exists by URL	users/{uid}/articles	O(1)	where('url', '=', url).limit(1) — single-field auto index
Count articles	users/{uid}/articles	O(1)	getCountFromServer() — doesn't download docs
User's support requests	supportRequests	O(n)	Composite index: userId ASC + createdAt DESC

12.3 Scaling Bottlenecks

COMPONENT	CURRENT LIMIT	WHEN IT BREAKS	SOLUTION
Groq free tier	~30 req/min	~200 DAU	Upgrade to Groq paid tier (\$0.05/M input tokens)
HuggingFace free tier	~100 req/hour	~50-100 DAU	Self-host Kokoro or upgrade HF Pro (\$9/mo)
Firestore reads	50K/day (free tier)	~500 DAU	Blaze plan (\$0.06/100K reads)
Cloud Function invocations	2M/mo (free tier)	~2000 DAU	Already on Blaze plan for external HTTP
Client-side sorting	500 docs max	Premium heavy users	Server-side pagination + composite indexes

13. Monitoring & Observability

SIGNAL	TOOL	LOCATION
Function logs	Cloud Logging (<code>logger.info/error</code>)	Firebase Console → Functions → Logs
Error tracking	Firestore <code>/errors</code> collection	Written by <code>summarizeArticle</code> on failure
Analytics	Firebase Analytics (<code>G-039HM57SZ4</code>)	GA4 dashboard
Uptime	Firebase Hosting CDN	99.95% SLA
Deployment status	GitHub Actions	Two workflows: hosting + functions
Support tickets	Email (Gmail) + Firestore	<code>onSupportRequestCreated</code> → admin email notification
Payment events	Paddle Dashboard + Cloud Logging	<code>paddleWebhook</code> logs all events

Recommended alert: Set up a Cloud Logging alert on `severity=ERROR` for the `summarizeArticle` and `readArticle` functions to get notified when AI API calls fail.